

Word family: **gather / gathers / gathered / gathering / gatherer**

Base word: gather

Past tense / past participle: gathered

ing form: gathering

Related forms:

* **gathering** (n.) — 聚會；聚集；集會

* **gatherer** (n.) — 採集者；收集者

* **hunter-gatherer** (n.) — 狩獵採集者

* **gathered** (adj./participle) — 聚集的；收攏的；打褶的

Useful extensions:

* **gather people together**

* **gather around**

* **gather information / evidence / data**

* **gather strength / courage / momentum**

* **gather speed**

* **gather dust**

* **gather your thoughts**

* **gather yourself**

* **a family gathering**

* **social gathering**

* **gathered skirt / gathered fabric**

Part of speech: mainly **verb**, with **gathering** as an important noun.

Meaning in this passage

> I still remember one family **gathering** when a younger child accidentally broke a cardboard bridge he had spent a long time making.

Here, **gathering** means:

a social occasion when people come together in one place — 聚會；聚集活動

More specifically:

family gathering = 家庭聚會；家人聚在一起的場合

中文翻譯：

我仍然記得有一次**家庭聚會**，一個年紀較小的孩子不小心弄壞了 Leo 花了很長時間製作的紙板橋。

So the passage uses the noun **gathering**, not the verb **gather**.

1. **gather people together** (使人聚集) — 召集；把人聚在一起

Practice 1

> The teacher **gathered the students together** before the trip.

老師在出發前把學生**召集在一起**。

Practice 2

> She **gathered everyone together** for a family photo.

她把大家**叫到一起**拍家庭照。

MCQ-ready definition:

gather people together = 使一群人來到同一地點並聚在一起

2. **people gather** (人群聚集) — 聚集；集合

Here, **gather** is intransitive.

Practice 1

> A crowd **gathered** outside the building.

一群人**聚集在**大樓外。

Practice 2

> The family **gathered** around the table for dinner.

一家人晚飯時**聚在**桌旁。

MCQ-ready definition:

gather = 人們從不同地方來到同一處並聚集起來

3. **gather around — 圍聚；聚到……周圍**

Practice 1

> The children **gathered around** the teacher.

孩子們**圍在老師身邊**。

Practice 2

> Everyone **gathered around** the cake.

大家都**圍到蛋糕旁邊**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gather around = 聚集到某人或某物四周****

4. **gather something together — 收集；把東西集中起來**

Practice 1

> She **gathered her books together** and left the room.

她把書**收集起來**，然後離開房間。

Practice 2

> We **gathered all the documents together** before the meeting.

開會前，我們把所有文件**集中在一起**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gather something together = 把分散的物件收集並集中到一起****

5. **gather flowers / fruit / crops — 採集；採摘；收割**

A traditional but still useful literal sense.

Practice 1

> The children **gathered wild flowers** in the field.

孩子們在田野裏**採摘野花**。

Practice 2

> Farmers were **gathering the harvest** before the rain arrived.

農夫趕在下雨前**收割農作物**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gather = 從自然環境或田地中採集、採摘或收取某些東西****

6. ****gather information / evidence / data — 蒐集資料 / 證據 / 數據****

This is one of the most important abstract extensions.

Practice 1

> The police are **gathering evidence**.

警方正在**蒐集證據**。

Practice 2

> We need to **gather more information** before making a decision.

作決定前，我們需要**蒐集更多資料**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gather information/evidence/data = 從不同來源收集資料，供了解、分析或作決定使用****

7. ****gather facts / details — 蒐集事實 / 細節****

Practice 1

> The journalist spent weeks **gathering facts**.

那名記者花了數星期**蒐集資料和事實**。

Practice 2

> Investigators are still **gathering details** about what happened.

調查人員仍在**蒐集事件細節**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gather facts/details = 把零散的事實或細節收集起來****

8. ****gather from something that... — 從.....得知 / 推斷****

This is a distinct and very useful sense.

Practice 1

> I ****gather from your email that**** the meeting has been cancelled.

我****從你的電郵得知 / 推斷出****會議已取消。

Practice 2

> From what I ****gather****, they are planning to move abroad.

****據我所了解****，他們正計劃移居外國。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gather that... / gather from... = 根據聽到、看到或讀到的資訊推斷或了解到某事****

9. ****I gather... — 據我了解；我聽說****

Often used in conversation.

Practice 1

> ****I gather**** you've already spoken to the manager.

****據我了解****，你已經跟經理談過了。

Practice 2

> ****I gather**** the event went very well.

****我聽說 / 據我了解****，活動進行得很順利。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****I gather... = 根據自己獲得的資訊，相信或了解到某件事****

****Register:** neutral to slightly formal.**

10. ****gather strength — 恢復 / 積聚力量****

Practice 1

> She rested for a while to ****gather her strength****.

她休息了一會兒，以****恢復體力****。

Practice 2

> He paused to ****gather strength**** before climbing again.

他停下來****積聚力量****，然後再繼續攀爬。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gather strength = 逐漸恢復或積聚體力、力量****

11. ****gather courage — 鼓起勇氣****

Practice 1

> She finally ****gathered the courage**** to speak.

她終於****鼓起勇氣****開口。

Practice 2

> He had to ****gather his courage**** before entering the room.

他進房前必須先****鼓起勇氣****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gather courage = 逐漸讓自己有足夠勇氣去做某件困難或令人害怕的事****

12. ****gather your thoughts — 整理思緒；集中想法****

Practice 1

> Give me a moment to **gather my thoughts**.

給我一點時間**整理一下思緒**。

Practice 2

> She paused before answering to **gather her thoughts**.

她回答前停了一下，**整理自己的想法**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gather your thoughts = 把腦中的想法整理好，以便清楚思考或表達****

13. **gather yourself — 使自己鎮定；恢復控制**

A figurative extension.

Practice 1

> He took a deep breath and **gathered himself**.

他深呼吸了一下，讓自己**鎮定下來**。

Practice 2

> She needed a few minutes to **gather herself** after hearing the news.

聽到消息後，她需要幾分鐘**平復情緒**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gather yourself = 在情緒激動後重新控制自己、恢復鎮定****

14. **gather speed — 加速；逐漸變快**

Practice 1

> The train **gathered speed** as it left the station.

火車離站後逐漸**加速**。

Practice 2

> The bicycle **gathered speed** on the downhill slope.

單車在下坡時**逐漸加快速度**。

MCQ-ready definition:

gather speed = 速度逐漸增加

15. **gather momentum — 勢頭增強；逐漸形成動力**

Practice 1

> The campaign is **gathering momentum**.

這項活動的**勢頭正在增強**。

Practice 2

> Support for the idea **gathered momentum** over the summer.

整個夏天，支持這個想法的**聲勢逐漸增強**。

MCQ-ready definition:

gather momentum = 某項活動、趨勢或發展逐漸取得更多力量、支持或速度

16. **clouds gather / darkness gathers — 雲層 / 黑暗逐漸聚集**

Often somewhat literary or descriptive.

Practice 1

> Dark clouds **gathered** over the mountains.

烏雲在山上空**逐漸聚集**。

Practice 2

> Darkness **gathered** around the village.

村莊四周的天色**逐漸暗下來**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gather = 某種自然現象逐漸增多、聚集或變得更明顯****

17. ****gather dust — 積塵；久置不用****

Literal and figurative.

Practice 1

> The old books were ****gathering dust**** on the shelf.

那些舊書一直放在架上****積塵****。

Practice 2

> His guitar has been ****gathering dust**** since he started working full-time.

自從他開始全職工作，那把結他便一直****放着不用****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gather dust = 因長時間沒有使用而積滿灰塵；引申為被擱置不用****

18. ****gathering (聚會) — 聚會；集會****

This is the meaning in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I still remember one family ****gathering****.

我仍然記得有一次家庭****聚會****。

Practice 2

> We had a small ****gathering**** at home on Saturday.

星期六我們在家舉行了一個小型****聚會****。

Practice 3

> The event attracted a large ****gathering**** of local residents.

這項活動吸引了大批當地居民**聚集參加**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gathering = 一群人為社交、慶祝、討論或其他目的聚在一起的場合****

19. ****family gathering — 家庭聚會****

Practice 1

> We usually have a ****family gathering**** during the holidays.

假期期間，我們通常會舉行****家庭聚會****。

Practice 2

> He met his cousins at a ****family gathering****.

他在一次****家庭聚會****上見到了幾位表兄弟姊妹。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****family gathering = 家庭成員聚在一起見面、吃飯或慶祝的場合****

20. ****social gathering — 社交聚會****

Practice 1

> The club organizes regular ****social gatherings****.

這個會定期舉辦****社交聚會****。

Practice 2

> It was meant to be an informal ****social gathering****.

那原本只是一個非正式的****社交聚會****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****social gathering = 人們主要為社交、交流或娛樂而聚在一起的活動****

21. ****gathering (人群) — 聚集的人群****

Practice 1

> A small **gathering** formed outside the station.

車站外聚起了一小群**人群**。

Practice 2

> Police watched the **gathering** carefully.

警方密切留意那群**聚集的人**。

MCQ-ready definition:

gathering = 聚在同一地方的一群人

22. **gathering** (收集過程) — 蒐集；收集

Often appears in compounds.

Practice 1

> Data **gathering** took several months.

資料蒐集花了幾個月。

Practice 2

> Information **gathering** is an important part of the investigation.

情報 / 資料蒐集是調查的重要部分。

MCQ-ready definition:

gathering = 把資訊、資料或物品收集起來的過程

23. **gathered fabric / gathered skirt** — 打褶的；收褶的

A distinct clothing/sewing use.

Practice 1

> The dress has a **gathered waist**.

這條裙的腰部採用了**收褶設計**。

Practice 2

> She wore a **gathered skirt**.

她穿了一條**有褶皺的裙子**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gathered = 布料被收攏成細小褶皺的****

24. **gatherer — 收集者；採集者**

Practice 1

> He was an enthusiastic **gatherer of old photographs**.

他很熱衷於**收集舊照片**。

Practice 2

> Early communities included hunters and **gatherers**.

早期社群包括獵人和**採集者**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gatherer = 收集或採集東西的人****

25. **hunter-gatherer — 狩獵採集者**

A common anthropology/history term.

Practice 1

> Early **hunter-gatherers** moved from place to place in search of food.

早期**狩獵採集者**會四處遷移尋找食物。

Practice 2

> The course examines **hunter-gatherer societies**.

這門課研究**狩獵採集社會**。

MCQ-ready definition:

hunter-gatherer = 主要靠狩獵動物及採集野生植物維生的人

Important distinction 1: **gather vs collect**

These overlap strongly.

gather

often emphasizes **bringing scattered things together**, and can also apply to people, information, courage, thoughts, clouds, etc.

> **gather information**

蒐集資料

> people **gather**

人群聚集

collect

often emphasizes deliberately accumulating items.

> **collect stamps**

集郵

You would normally say:

>  people **gathered** outside

not:

>  people collected outside

when you mean people assembled naturally.

Important distinction 2: **gather vs assemble**

gather

ordinary and natural.

> The family **gathered** in the living room.

一家人在客廳聚集。

assemble

more formal and often organized.

> The students **assembled** in the hall.

學生在禮堂集合。

So **assemble** often suggests a more deliberate or official arrangement.

Important distinction 3: **gather vs meet**

meet

focuses on people coming together or encountering each other.

gather

focuses on the formation of a group in one place.

> We **met** at the café.

我們在咖啡店見面。

> A crowd **gathered** outside the café.

一群人聚集在咖啡店外。

Important distinction 4: **gather vs pick**

With flowers or fruit:

pick

focuses on removing individual items.

> ****pick apples****

摘蘋果

****gather****

focuses more on collecting a quantity together.

> ****gather berries****

採集漿果

They can overlap, but the viewpoint differs.

Important distinction 5: ****gather information vs learn information****

****gather information****

= actively collect it from multiple sources

****learn information****

= come to know it

> We ****gathered information**** from several reports.

我們從幾份報告中蒐集資料。

> We ****learned**** that the meeting had been cancelled.

我們得知會議已取消。

Important distinction 6: ****gather that... vs know that...****

****know that****

you possess the information as a fact.

****gather that****

you have ****inferred or learned it indirectly****.

> I ****know**** she has resigned.

我知道她辭職了。

> I ****gather**** she has resigned.

據我了解 / 我聽說她辭職了。

So ****gather**** often contains more distance or uncertainty.

Important distinction 7: ****gather together — is “together” necessary?****

Not always.

> The students ****gathered**** outside.

already means they came together.

> The teacher ****gathered the students together****.

Here ****together**** adds clarity/emphasis, but ****gather**** itself already contains the idea of bringing together.

So ****gather together**** is common, but partly redundant.

Important distinction 8: ****gather strength vs regain strength****

****gather strength****

often suggests ****building up enough strength for the next action****

> She paused to ****gather her strength****.

她停下來積聚力量。

****regain strength****

emphasizes ****recovering strength that was lost****

> She slowly **regained her strength** after the illness.

病後她慢慢恢復體力。

They overlap, but the perspective differs.

Important distinction 9: **gather your thoughts** vs **think**

think

very broad mental activity.

gather your thoughts

specifically means bringing scattered/confused thoughts under control before speaking or acting.

> Let me **gather my thoughts**.

讓我先整理一下思緒。

It often appears after shock, interruption, confusion, or emotional pressure.

Important distinction 10: **gather speed** vs **speed up**

Both mean become faster.

gather speed

emphasizes a **gradual increase**.

> The train **gathered speed**.

火車逐漸加速。

speed up

more neutral and general.

> The train **sped up**.

火車加速了。

Important distinction 11: **gathering** vs **meeting**

gathering

usually emphasizes people coming together socially or generally.

> a family **gathering**

家庭聚會

meeting

usually has a clearer purpose such as discussion, decision-making, work, or administration.

> a staff **meeting**

員工會議

A family event is naturally a **gathering**, not usually a **meeting**.

Important distinction 12: **gathering** vs **party**

gathering

broad and neutral; can be formal, informal, social, family, political, religious, etc.

party

usually more specifically social and celebratory.

> a small family **gathering**

小型家庭聚會

does not necessarily mean there was a party.

Important distinction 13: **gathering** vs **crowd**

gathering

can refer to an ****organized event**** or the people gathered.

****crowd****

mainly refers to ****a large group of people**** physically present together.

> a family ****gathering****

家庭聚會

> a large ****crowd****

一大群人

So in your passage, ****family gathering**** is about the ****occasion****, not simply the number of people.

Family-extension note

****Gather**** has a very coherent semantic structure built around one core image:

****separate things or people come together / are brought together****

From that, English develops several useful branches:

1. ****people come together****

- * people gather
- * gather around
- * family gathering

2. ****things are collected****

- * gather books
- * gather flowers
- * gather evidence

3. ****information is accumulated****

- * gather data
- * gather that...

4. ****abstract resources accumulate****

- * gather strength
- * gather courage
- * gather momentum
- * gather speed

5. **mental/emotional control**

- * gather your thoughts
- * gather yourself

These are worth teaching, but we should not treat every collocation as an unrelated lexical sense. **Gather strength**, **gather courage**, **gather speed**, and **gather momentum** all preserve the metaphorical idea of something **building up or accumulating**.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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people gather	人群聚集	come together
gather people together	召集人群	bring people together
gather around	圍聚	assemble around something
gather things together	收集；集中	bring scattered items together
gather flowers/fruit	採集；採摘	collect from nature
gather information	蒐集資料	collect information
gather evidence	蒐集證據	collect proof
gather that...	據了解；推斷	infer from information
I gather...	我聽說 / 據我了解	indirect understanding
gather strength	積聚 / 恢復力量	build strength
gather courage	鼓起勇氣	build courage
gather your thoughts	整理思緒	organize thoughts
gather yourself	鎮定自己	regain emotional control
gather speed	逐漸加速	build speed
gather momentum	勢頭增強	build force/support
clouds gather	雲層聚集	accumulate naturally
gather dust	積塵；久置不用	accumulate dust
gathering	聚會；集會	occasion when people assemble
family gathering	家庭聚會	family social occasion
social gathering	社交聚會	social event
a gathering of people	聚集的人群	assembled group
data gathering	資料蒐集	collection process
gathered fabric	收褶布料	fabric drawn into folds
gatherer	採集者；收集者	person who gathers
hunter-gatherer	狩獵採集者	subsistence lifestyle

For your original sentence

> I still remember one family **gathering** when a younger child accidentally broke a cardboard bridge he had spent a long time making.

Here:

gathering = 聚會；一群人聚在一起的場合

and specifically:

family gathering = 家庭聚會

The semantic path is very transparent:

people gather = 人們聚在一起

→ **a gathering** = 一次人們聚在一起的場合

→ **a family gathering** = 一次家人聚在一起的場合

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 我仍然記得有一次**家庭聚會**.....

So for this passage, the key item is the **event noun `gathering`**, rather than the basic verb meaning **收集**.